

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

What happened to your car? Were you in an accident?



Learning Outcome

Describe situations in written and spoken interactions according to social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How often are there car accidents on the streets in your city?
- Are they usually minor or major accidents?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about friendship, relationships, feelings and reactions.
- I can tell stories and anecdotes and talk about experiences I've had or haven't had.
- I can talk about things that happened or were happening.





Let's Explore!

They haven't passed any laws **specifically*** connected to skating.

* "Specifically" means clearly identified.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Last Wednesday, a car hit an eighteen-year-old in-line skater. "I was turning right into a quiet side street, and he just appeared!" exclaimed the driver. "I've never had an accident in my life, and today I put someone in the hospital."

In-line skating, also called rollerblading, has become a popular form of transportation on city streets. However, skating has also been the cause of many road accidents in the past couple of years.

"This has become a serious safety problem in the city," stated the mayor. "We haven't passed any specific laws connected to skating. We haven't decided which traffic laws skaters must obey. We started discussing this in September but haven't made any decisions yet." While I was talking to Janice Marcus, the head of Skaters for Safety, she said that she was afraid that laws were going to limit the freedom of in-line skaters. She told me that Skaters for Safety was organizing a skaters' march to show that they wanted a fair shake.

James Hiro, the skater injured in last Wednesday's accident, said he was angrier at himself than at the driver and admitted he should have been more careful. "I've been skating for the past two years, and, believe me, I've had many close shaves," he said. "I'm just glad I was wearing a helmet."





Let's Practice!

James Hiro had an accident.

Instructions: Circle all the adjectives in the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. The head of Skaters for Safety said that she was afraid that laws were going to limit the freedom of in-line skaters.
2. James Hiro was injured in last Wednesday's accident.
3. Hiro was angrier at himself than at the driver.
4. He admitted he should have been more careful.
5. He's just glad he was wearing a helmet.



Let's Practice!

What has become a serious problem in the city? Let's find out.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences.

1. had / my / accident / never / today / put / someone / and / I've / in / hospital. / an / life / the / I / in

2. has / the / problem / serious / city," / a / stated / "This / become / in / mayor. / safety / the

3. passed / specific / haven't / laws / connected / any / skating. / to / We

4. to / said / freedom / skaters. / were / she / that / limit / that / going / of / afraid / was / She / in-line / the / laws

5. started / yet. / September / but / decisions / in / any / discussing / made / this / We / haven't





Extension Activity

Discuss the pros and cons of in-line skating on the street.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Brainstorm ideas about the pros and cons of in-line skating on the street with a partner.
- Back each statement up with an example from your experience, what you have read, or from your imagination.
- Now make sentences stating pros or cons and backing them up.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I brainstorm ideas with a partner about the pros and cons of in-line skating on the street.

☐ ☐

I back up each statement with an anecdote in the Past Simple tense or Present Perfect tense.

☐ ☐

I make sentences using the pros and cons and backup point.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- in-line skates** (noun): a shoe with a single row of small wheels on the bottom, worn in order to travel faster for fun, sport or exercise
e.g. In-line skating has become a popular form of transportation on city streets.
- to put someone in the hospital** (expression): to severely injure someone
e.g. Today I put someone in the hospital.
- to rollerblade** (noun): to move over a hard surface while wearing in-line skates
e.g. In-line skating is also called rollerblading.
- skater** (noun): a person who rollerblades
e.g. James Hiro was the skater injured in last Wednesday's accident.
- a fair shake** (expression): to give or to get a fair chance or fair treatment
e.g. They organized a skaters' march to show that they wanted a fair shake.
- a close shave** (expression): a narrow escape from danger or disaster
e.g. I've had many close shaves.





Learning Points

The Past Continuous Tense vs. The Simple Past Tense

You use the Past Continuous tense to talk about an action that was happening (in progress) at a time before now.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

You can use the Past Continuous to describe the background in a story written in the past tense.

You often use the Simple Past and the Past Continuous together. You can use the Past Continuous to describe an action that was interrupted by another event or action (Simple Past).

For example:

*"I **was turning** right into a quiet side street, and he just **appeared!**"*

The form of the Past Continuous is:

Subject + *was/were* + verb-*ing*

Examples:

- *Last Wednesday, a car hit an eighteen-year-old in-line skater.*
- *While I was talking to Janice Marcus, the head of Skaters for Safety, she said that she was afraid that laws were going to limit the freedom of in-line skaters.*
- *She told me that Skaters for Safety was organizing a skaters' march to show that they wanted a fair shake.*
- *I'm just glad I was wearing a helmet.*

The Present Perfect Tense vs. The Simple Past Tense

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about a past action or an action that began in the past that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

You can use the Present Perfect tense to talk about experience.

When you use the Present Perfect tense, you think about the past and present together. There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

For example:





Learning Points

I have learned English. = I learned English in the past and now I can speak English.

In-line skating has become a popular form of transportation. = In-line skating began to be popular in the past and is now popular.

It is common to use *for* and *since* when referring to time periods in the Present Perfect:

- You use **FOR** to talk about how long an action has been happening (a week, two days, five hours, six years, etc.)
- You use **SINCE** to talk about when the action started (2010, Monday, she was a child)

Usually, when you use the Simple Past tense, the time of the finished action is clear from the context or explicitly mentioned in the sentence.

For example:

Yesterday, I went to the store.

We **started** discussing this in September.

It is clear when the action occurred. In this sentence we would not use the Present Perfect. (~~Yesterday, I have been to the store.~~)

The structure of the Present Perfect is:

Subject	has/have (not/never)	past participle	
I	have never	had	an accident.
In-line skating	has	become	popular.

Examples:

- *However, skating has also been the cause of many road accidents in the past couple of years.*
- *I've never had an accident in my life.*
- *In-line skating, also called rollerblading, has become a popular form of transportation on city streets. However, skating has also been the cause of many road accidents in the past couple of years.*
- *I've had many close shaves.*
- *We started discussing this in September but haven't made any decisions yet.*

